

Data Analysis Workbook

Step-by-step guidance for Workstream B

Client	Generation Bridge Foundation
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Classification	Participant material - Workstream B
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This workbook explains, in plain language, how to complete each analysis task in Excel. You do not need to write any code. If your team chooses to use Python or R, the same standards of documentation and interpretation apply.

Concepts in plain English

Term	What it means
Pivot table	A table that groups and summarises your data automatically
XLOOKUP	Finds a value in one table and returns a matching value from another
Placement rate	Placed completers divided by total completers - define both parts
Correlation	Two things move together; it does not prove one causes the other
Confounder	A hidden factor that affects both things you are comparing
Selection bias	Those who attend more may already differ in ways that affect outcomes

Worked approach to DB-3 (attendance and outcomes)

1. In programme_attendance, create a helper column that is 1 when the young person attended and 0 when they did not, normalising the mixed Y/N/1/0 coding.
2. Build a pivot table to get each young person's attendance rate: sessions attended divided by sessions offered.
3. Use XLOOKUP to bring in the placement outcome from employment_outcomes.
4. Compare the average attendance of those placed with those not placed.
5. Write two or three sentences interpreting the gap, and name the confounders. For example: those facing transport barriers may miss both sessions and internships, so lower attendance may be a symptom, not a cause.

Reporting standards

- State the placement definition you used and why.
- Never delete an outlier silently - investigate it and record the decision.
- Give every chart a title that states the finding.
- Note the sample-size limitation: this export is smaller than the full 2,847.